

THE LEADER'S VACATION

Nobody finds out whether the operation runs alone on the day of the trip.

How to make the operation run when you are not there.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

You find out in the rehearsals before it.

THE CASCADE

The preparation that prepares nothing.

WHAT YOU SEE

The night before you write a giant handover doc...

THE MECHANISM

...you travel, but keep answering messages...

THE CONSEQUENCE

...and the team learns that waiting for you is faster.

Whoever answers on vacation teaches the team never to decide alone.

THE FORK

What keeps the operation in your hands.

WHAT HOLDS IT

01

Only you have the access or the password? Technical dependence.

02

Only you can approve? Decision ceiling dependence.

03

Only you know why things are the way they are? Criteria dependence.

The third is the worst, because a shared password does not fix it.

THE METHOD

The absence rehearsal, four stages.

01 **HALF A MORNING**

answer nothing, then look at what stalled

02 **ONE DAY**

no meetings with you, the team decides and tells
you next day

03 **THREE DAYS**

owners named per area and an escalation rule

04 **TWO WEEKS**

the real absence, which now only confirms
what was tested

Every stage breaks something. That is what it is for.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

Four things that stand in for you.

01 • HALF A
MORNING

One owner per area.

a first and last name, not a committee of three

02 • ONE DAY

Three visible numbers.

who watches, how often, and what bad looks like

03 • THREE DAYS

A plan for the most likely problem.

the one that has already happened twice this year

04 • TWO WEEKS

The rule for calling me.

define what serious means, or they call for everything, or nothing

TWO MODELS

A handover or an operation with owners.

THE COMMON MODEL

Night before handover

A long document nobody reads

Everything escalates to you

Decisions wait for your return

You come back to fight fires

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Operation with owners

An owner per area, ceiling in writing

Escalation only for the serious

Decisions happen and get logged

You come back to review, not to repair

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three habits that keep you from leaving.

01 Solving it fast because explaining takes longer.

- saves ten minutes today and costs your freedom later.
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02 Reviewing everything before you go, even what is not yours.

- reviewing everything is micromanagement wearing the word care.
-

03 Answering from the beach, in two minutes.

- each quick reply cancels an entire rehearsal.
-

You are not irreplaceable, you just never gave anyone the chance to replace you.

THE CHAIN

The three questions test.

01

Ask each owner, what is the goal of your area?



02

And which metrics say whether it is healthy?



03

And what is the plan if it breaks? No answer? Not an owner.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Five minutes per person and you know exactly where the operation stalls.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

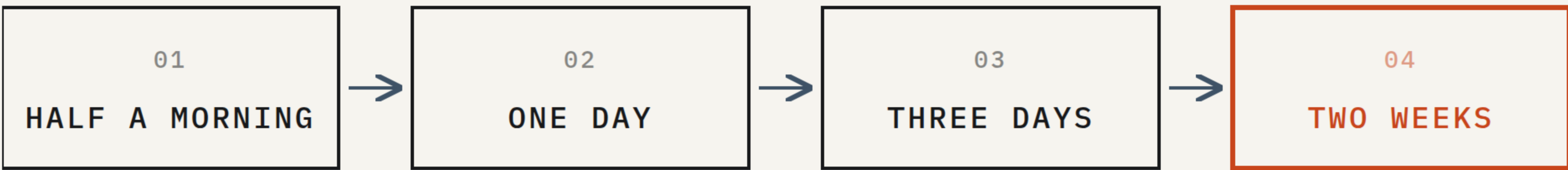
Start with the cheapest rehearsal.

▣ STEP 01 Pick one morning and answer nothing. write down what stalled, that list is your work plan	▣ STEP 02 Name one owner per area, with the ceiling in one line. amount, type of decision and what has to escalate	■ STEP 03 Agree the phone call rule, what actually counts as serious. a client stopped, money at risk, safety, everything else waits
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| If the rehearsal hurts, good, it hurts now and not on your trip.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Absence Rehearsal, in the order that matters.



An operation that only runs with you present is not an operation, it is dependence.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER
before your next vacation.

FABIO GARCIA
MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA